

RISE & SHINE ABA

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Empowering children to reach their full potential

PARENT WELCOME PACKET

Everything you need to know about your child's ABA services

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SECTION 1

Welcome Letter

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Welcome to Rise & Shine ABA. We are honored that you have chosen us to support your child's growth and development.

Our team of Board Certified Behavior Analysts (BCBAs) and Registered Behavior Technicians (RBTs) provides high-quality, evidence-based Applied Behavior Analysis tailored to your child. We believe every child has the potential to thrive, and we are here to help your family at every step.

This packet explains what happens next, what we need from you, and what you can expect from us. Please read it carefully — particularly Section 2, which sets out an honest timeline, and Section 3, which lists the documents we need before we can begin.

One thing we want to say plainly at the outset: **much of how quickly your child can start depends on your insurance company, not on us.** We will be transparent with you about where things stand at every stage, including when the delay is on the insurer's side and there is nothing further we can do to speed it up. You will never have to wonder.

If you have questions at any point, please call. We would always rather answer a question twice than have you worry once.

With warmth and dedication,

The Rise & Shine ABA Team

SECTION 2

What to Expect

Starting ABA involves several steps. Here is the whole journey, start to finish.

Step 1 — Intake and Document Collection

You complete the Client Intake Form and the Consent & Authorization Form, and send us the documents listed in Section 3. We will provide a secure link for uploading them.

This is the step you control, and it is the one that most often determines how fast everything else moves. A complete, accurate packet on day one can save weeks later.

Step 2 — Insurance Verification

Our billing team verifies your child's coverage: whether ABA is covered, what your plan requires, whether authorization is needed, and what (if anything) you may owe out of pocket. We will tell you what we find.

Step 3 — Prior Authorization for the Assessment

Almost every insurance plan requires written approval before ABA can begin. We submit that request. The insurance company then takes as long as it takes — commonly one to three weeks, sometimes longer.

We cannot schedule your child's assessment until the insurance company approves it. If we did, and they later denied the request, you could be left with a bill. We will not put your family in that position.

Step 4 — Meet & Greet

You meet your child's BCBA before the assessment. This is a conversation, not a test. We talk about your child, your goals, your household, and your schedule. Bring every question you have.

Step 5 — BCBA Assessment

The BCBA observes your child, interviews you, and completes standardized assessments to understand your child's strengths, needs, and goals.

Step 6 — Treatment Plan

Your BCBA writes an individualized treatment plan with specific, measurable goals. You review it and we discuss it together before anything is submitted or begun.

Step 7 — Prior Authorization for Treatment

We submit the treatment plan to your insurance company and request approval for the recommended therapy hours. This is a second approval, separate from Step 3, and it also takes time.

Sometimes an insurer approves fewer hours than the BCBA recommended. If that happens, we will tell you, explain what it means, and discuss whether to appeal.

Step 8 — Therapist Matching

We match your child with an RBT based on your availability, location, language, and any preferences you have shared. Specific availability helps enormously here.

Step 9 — Services Begin

Your child's first session will have a BCBA present, alongside the RBT. The BCBA is there to model the plan, make sure it works in your actual home, and answer your questions in the moment.

Step 10 — Ongoing Therapy and Progress Review

Your RBT delivers sessions under BCBA supervision. Your BCBA reviews data, updates goals, meets with you, and provides caregiver training. Authorizations must be renewed periodically — we handle that, and we start early.

An Honest Timeline

Most families begin therapy 6 to 10 weeks after first contacting us. The largest single factor is how long your insurance company takes to approve services — which is outside our control. We would rather tell you this now than have you expect a start date we cannot deliver.

Stage	Typical time	Who controls it
Intake forms and documents	1–7 days	You
Insurance verification	2 business days	Us
Assessment authorization request submitted	2 business days	Us
Insurance decides on assessment	1–3 weeks	Your insurer
Meet & Greet	Within 1 week of approval	Us + you
Assessment completed	1–2 weeks	Us
Treatment plan written	About 1 week	Us
Insurance decides on treatment hours	1–3 weeks	Your insurer
Therapist matched and first session	1–2 weeks	Us + you

Two things you can do to make this faster: send us a complete document packet the first time, and give us specific availability. Those two things alone commonly save two to three weeks.

SECTION 3

What We Need From You

We cannot begin insurance verification without items 1 and 2, and we cannot request authorization without items 3 and 4. Everything else helps us serve your child better.

#	Document	Needed for
1	Completed Client Intake Form (Form 01)	Everything
2	Signed Consent & Authorization Form (Form 02)	Everything
3	Insurance card — front and back	Insurance verification
4	Medicaid card, if applicable — front and back	Insurance verification
5	Diagnostic evaluation report (DSM-5 autism diagnosis)	Authorization
6	Physician referral or prescription for ABA	Authorization
7	IEP or IFSP, if your child has one	Treatment planning
8	Custody or guardianship order, if applicable	Legal consent
9	Prior ABA records, if any	Continuity of care

A note for families with New York Medicaid

The ABA referral is where most delays happen. New York Medicaid will not approve services unless the referral contains every one of the following, and is signed by a physician, psychologist, psychiatric nurse practitioner, or pediatric nurse practitioner.

Please show this list to the provider writing the referral:

- Your child's age
- The ASD or Rett Syndrome diagnosis
- The date of the initial diagnosis
- Any co-occurring diagnoses
- Symptom severity or support level, if written by the diagnosing provider
- A statement confirming your child requires ABA services
- A DSM-5 Diagnostic Checklist supporting the ASD diagnosis

If your referral is missing any of these, we will tell you exactly what to ask for. Please do not be discouraged — this is common, and it is fixable.

How to send documents to us securely

- **Best:** use the secure upload link we email you.
- **Acceptable:** bring paper copies to your Meet & Greet.
- **Please avoid:** sending insurance cards, reports, or any health information by text message. Text messages are not encrypted.

SECTION 4

Frequently Asked Questions

What is ABA therapy?

Applied Behavior Analysis is an evidence-based approach to understanding and improving behavior. It uses positive reinforcement and individualized strategies to help children build communication, social skills, self-care, and learning readiness, and to reduce behaviors that interfere with learning or safety.

Who provides the therapy?

A Board Certified Behavior Analyst (BCBA) assesses your child, designs the treatment plan, and supervises care. A Registered Behavior Technician (RBT) delivers the day-to-day sessions. Your BCBA remains involved throughout and will be present at your child's first session.

Where do sessions take place?

Most sessions take place in your home. Depending on your child's goals, sessions may also occur in a clinic, in community settings, at school, or by telehealth. You consent to each setting separately on Form 02.

How many hours per week will my child receive?

That depends on your child's clinical needs and what your insurance authorizes. Your BCBA will recommend hours based on the assessment. Many children receive between 10 and 30 hours per week, though some receive fewer.

What if insurance approves fewer hours than the BCBA recommended?

We will tell you promptly, explain the difference, and discuss whether to appeal. We will not quietly reduce your child's therapy without talking to you first.

Will I be involved in the therapy?

Yes, and it matters. Caregiver training is a core part of ABA and is often required by insurance. Your BCBA will work with you directly. You are always welcome to observe sessions.

What is your cancellation policy?

We ask for at least 48 hours' notice whenever possible. If your child has Medicaid, you will never be charged a fee for a cancellation or a missed appointment. For families with commercial insurance, a late-cancellation fee may apply, and we will always tell you in writing before charging one. Illness and emergencies are never penalized.

Is ABA covered by insurance?

Most plans, including Medicaid and many commercial insurers, cover ABA when it is medically necessary. Our billing team verifies your coverage and manages the authorization process on your behalf.

Will I get a bill?

If your child has Medicaid, you will not be billed for covered services. If your child has commercial insurance, you may owe a deductible, copayment, or coinsurance, and we will tell you what to expect before services begin, whenever we can determine it in advance.

How do I communicate with the therapy team?

By phone at (888) 898-4774, by email at info@riseandshineaba.com, or through the method you selected on your consent form. Your BCBA will also schedule regular check-ins. Please do not send health information by text.

What if I want to change my child's therapist?

Just ask. A good fit between your child and their therapist matters, and requesting a change will never affect your child's care or how we treat your family.

How will I know if my child is making progress?

Your BCBA collects data at every session and will share graphs and written progress reports with you regularly. Treatment plans are reviewed and updated as your child grows.

What happens if my child's insurance changes or lapses?

Tell us immediately. Coverage changes are common and we can usually manage them — but only if we know. If coverage lapses, services may need to pause until it is restored, so early notice genuinely protects your child's therapy.

What if I have a concern or complaint?

Call us. We will acknowledge your concern within one business day and respond within five. You may also contact your health plan or your state Medicaid program directly at any time. Raising a concern will never affect your child's care.

SECTION 5

Your Rights as a Family

You and your child have the right to:

- Be treated with dignity and respect at all times.
- Receive services free from discrimination on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, age, or disability.
- Be fully informed about your child's treatment plan and to participate in decisions about it.
- Refuse any service, or withdraw your consent, at any time.
- Request a different therapist.
- Choose your ABA provider freely, and to change providers.
- See, and request corrections to, your child's records.
- Receive information in a language you understand, including interpretation services at no cost to you.
- Have your child's health information kept private, as described in our Notice of Privacy Practices.
- Raise a concern or file a complaint without any effect whatsoever on your child's care.

What we ask of you in return

- Tell us promptly if your insurance, address, phone number, or custody arrangement changes.
- Give us as much notice as you can when you need to cancel.
- Be present and available during in-home sessions, as your child's plan requires.
- Tell us when something is not working. We would much rather hear it early.

SECTION 6

How to Reach Us

	Contact
Main phone	(888) 898-4774
Email	info@riseandshineaba.com
Fax	(888) 898-6260
Website	www.riseandshineaba.com
Scheduling questions	(888) 898-4774
Billing and insurance questions	(888) 898-4774
Concerns or complaints	(888) 898-4774 or info@riseandshineaba.com

In an emergency

If your child is in immediate danger, call 911 first. Then call us at (888) 898-4774 so we can support you and adjust your child's plan as needed.

Our response commitments

When you contact us about...	You will hear back
A general question	Within 1 business day
A scheduling change	Within 1 business day
An authorization or insurance question	Within 1 business day
A concern or complaint	Acknowledged within 1 business day; substantive response within 5
A safety concern	Immediately

Thank you for trusting us with your child.

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